



Business Simulation — Our Story

Marketplace® Conscious Capitalism · Bikes · July 2026

“We lost the race — and built the machine that would win the next one.”

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Strategy & ambition

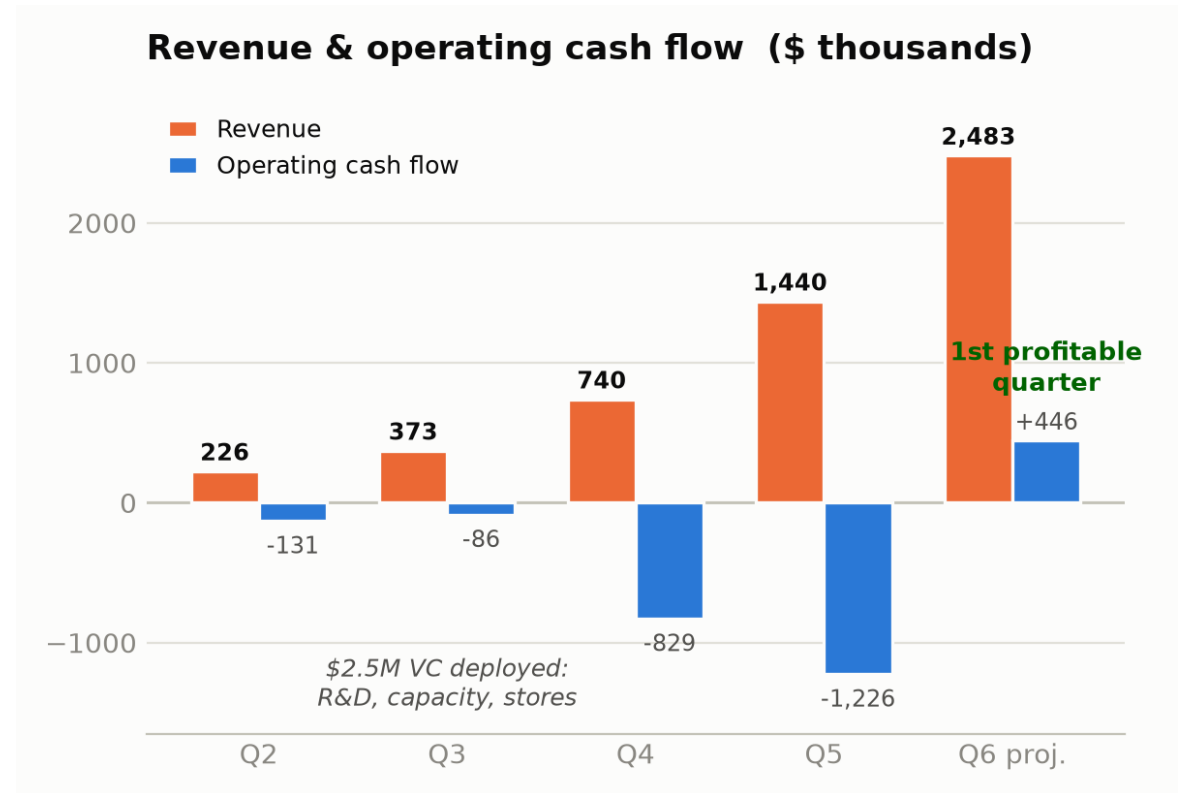
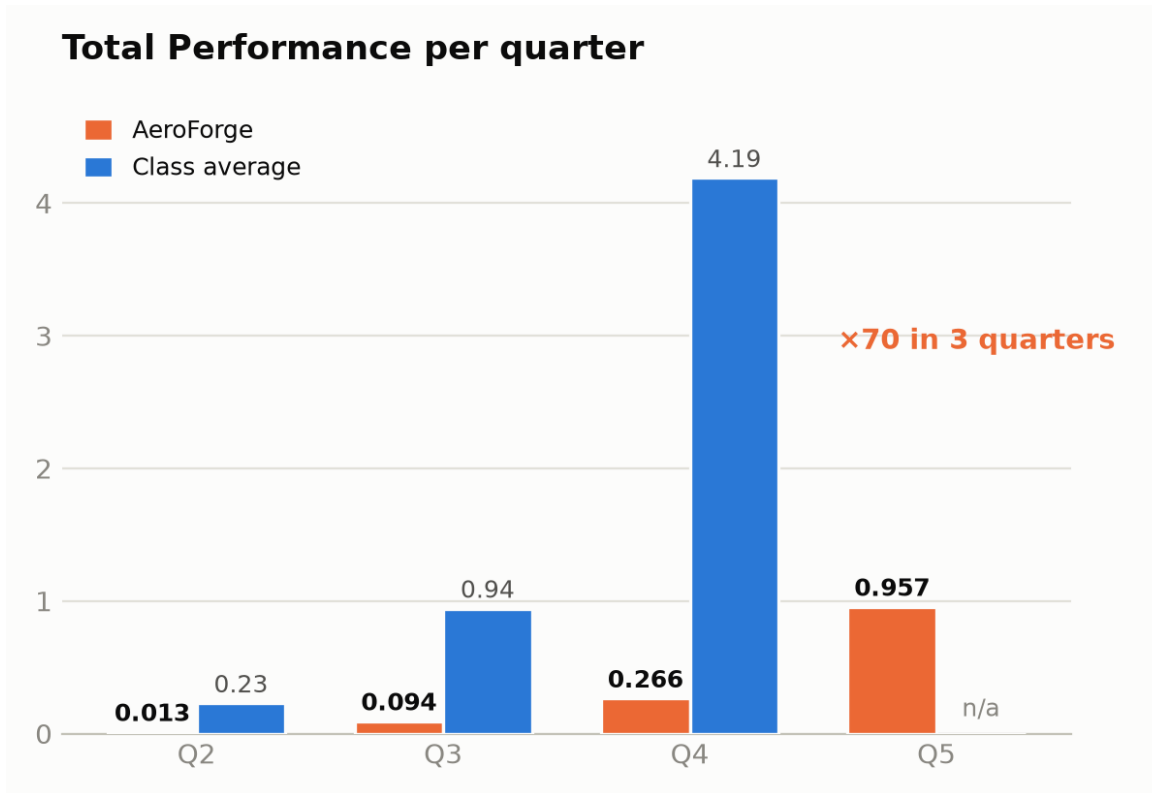
Mission — Elite carbon performance within everyone's reach — creating value for riders, employees, communities and the planet we ride through.

Targets & positioning — Primary: Mountain · Secondary: Speed. Premium, value-driven, conscious-capitalism positioning — win on product quality, never on price.

Footprint — New York City → Amsterdam (Q4, the game's largest market) → Bangalore (Q5). Funded by a \$2.5M venture round backed by our business plan.

Organization — A real executive committee: 6 VPs with clear ownership. Every decision argued with data; the President arbitrates.

Key results — the honest version



Cumulative scorecard: last. A cumulative index never forgives a failed test market — our Q2 hole followed us to the end.

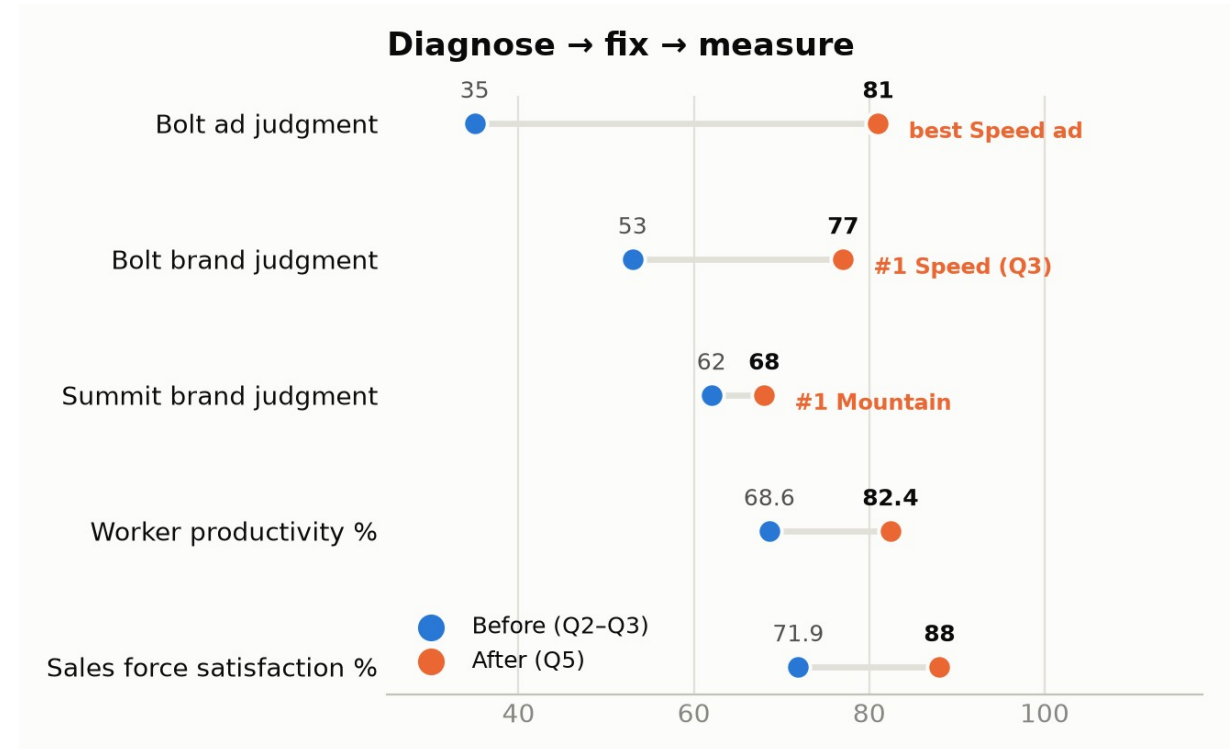
Conscious scorecard: only firm never cited for toxic leaks · employee satisfaction 88% · turnover 32%→11% · reputation above class average.

One failure, one success, one new method

Failure — designed by intuition — Q2 test market: a Speed ad built on Mountain claims (35/100) and “comfort” parts on a mountain bike (62 < the 70 recommendation threshold). Demand starved for two quarters.

Success — designed from data — From Q3: copy the revealed component matrices and leader ad structures. Bolt 53→77 (#1 Speed), ad 35→81 (best Speed ad), Summit #1 Mountain.

The method change, mid-week — Buy every study, justify every field with a number, verify every save — Check Ad Claims · Final Check · pro forma last.



Three lessons we'll keep

- 1 · Business disciplines are one system** — A 35/100 ad starves a factory; below-market pay cut productivity to 68.6% and cost us 88 sales. We never lost money “in finance” — we lost it in marketing and HR first.
- 2 · Under time pressure, intuition is a hypothesis — not a decision** — The test market exists to buy data before you bet. The ~\$45k of studies we skipped in Q2 cost us two quarters of momentum.
- 3 · Play the scorecard like an engineer** — Learn how each metric is computed, then work backwards. The ones winnable from day 1, we won: #1 in class on Investment in Future and Financial Risk. The cumulative one punishes early mistakes forever.
- + People tell you first** — In-basket memos about sick workers → clean-room investment → morale up, satisfaction 88%. Listen to the weak signals.

If we started over

Top recommendation — Spend your first dollar on information: buy every market study in Q2 and design from the component matrices — never from instinct. One failed quarter costs 50× the studies.

One thing we'd never do again — Ship anything unbenchmarked — an ad, a salary, a price. The market had already published the right answer; we just hadn't bought it.

AeroForge exits Q6: 100% enriched-carbon range · #1-rated Mountain product · first profitable quarter (+\$446k) · zero debt · #1 in class on Investment in Future

Our question for you: *your scorecard is cumulative too — which “Q2 mistake” are you still paying for, and have you actually diagnosed it?*